



NVIDIA 3D Vision 2

NVIDIA 3D Vision 2 introduces a new display technology called NVIDIA 3D light boost which should make your 3D experience brighter.

Glass Off

Apple will launch an application called the 'Glass Off' which will help people lose their reading glasses.

MAX 2011 in a Flash!

The latest news from Adobe MAX 2011, and how it will change your digital life!

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Adobe MAX 2011 is a yearly event that serves as the launchpad to announce revisions to Adobe's product offerings; including the Creative Suite, currently in version 5.5. It's an event with participation by designers, developers, customers and employees from across the globe. It's significant because it gives a feel of the vision, and innovation in a company like Adobe. Given its influence on the web, it is meant to be closely followed.

The general consensus among tech influencers (in the West) is that tablets would revolutionise the way we consume content. In recent years (this is less than 3 years that we're talking about), the web and communications media have changed manifold. Steve Jobs, who'll be missed, announced the iPad in 2010 and revolutionised the way we consume, experience and share information.

What tablets really revolutionised were the way applications are designed, and to a significant extent, it also enhanced the way standards were being looked at. UI and UX were terms that existed for a long time; but suddenly spiraled into popular vocabulary as a result of the phenomenal rise of Apple. Well, agreed, we're reporting on Adobe MAX 2011, so why discuss Apple?

It's significant because Steve Jobs, while he was launching his gamechangers stated that Flash won't be supported by them. What followed seemed to be war between Apple and Adobe. Although there was nothing of that sort, the world seemed to fuel such a spat to all possible extent. Soon we were hearing about the fall of Flash. Then came HTML5. The rising market share by Apple prompted other equipment manufacturers to launch their own tablets. We've seen Android, webOS, Windows and QNX

among the most prominent platforms that have been doing the rounds. While it was getting better for the consumer, the developer wasn't really happy with the situation. Coding for each platform needed investment.

You had to develop for Apple's iOS platform using its SDK using an Apple product such as a Mac within Apple's closed environment. Later, developers realised that Android is growing phenomenally too, and not one wanted to miss out on market share. Applications now had to be ported across platforms. Hiring separate teams meant investing in additional time and resources, thereby increasing cost.

Adobe, the game changer

That's when Adobe announced Flash Builder. You can now create your application that will run natively in an Adobe runtime (AIR) agnostic to the underlying operating system. Whether you want to cater to the Android Marketplace, Apple App Store, or BlackBerry App World, you can deploy apps to all of them with the assurance that they will run smoothly, from within the same code base. You just need to develop once. What we were sceptical about was the hype surrounding HTML5 as a Flash killer. This was a key question we sought an answer to. There were several announcements at MAX.

Announcements galore

Adobe began with a strong message. Flash or HTML5, Adobe will support both! They also announced their highest ever donation to the Mozilla Foundation. In addition to this, they acquired Nitobi, makers of Phon-



CEO Shantanu Narayen with CTO Kevin Lynch in a Q&A session

egap. Why is this significant? Well you can now develop for additional platforms using HTML5, CSS and JavaScript. Phonegap works by using these three technologies. It supports iOS, Android, BlackBerry, webOS, Symbian and bada. The most significant highlight of this move is that Adobe is promoting Phonegap further as an opensource product. The next announcement was also an acquisition of web font company Typekit.

With the acquisition of Typekit, you can now offer various fonts for your web site or application users. WebKit enables its font deliver mechanism by hundreds of servers globally located.

The groundbreaking announcement, however, was their thrust on Cloud computing. Adobe Creative Suite 5.5 will have 20 GB of Cloud storage and will sync your work across desktop, tablets and mobile devices. Besides this, Adobe launched 6 new touch based applications, including Photoshop Touch that enables performing complex operations possible only on desktops until now. **d**